DANNY WILSON

AWS Solutions Architect | Startup Founder | Full-Stack Cloud Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AWS cloud developer and startup founder who builds production, cloud-native applications and advises others doing the same. As the founder of an independent app development business, I live the startup reality daily: moving fast with tight resources while making pragmatic architectural decisions that scale instead of becoming bottlenecks. Hands-on across the AWS serverless stack (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Cognito, Amplify, S3, CloudFront) with practical experience integrating GenAI into real products. AWS Cloud Institute graduate and AWS-certified, Atlanta-based, with 15+ years in IT and a track record of shipping apps serving 250+ users.

WHAT I BRING TO FOUNDERS

- **I've been in their seat.** I run my own development business, so I understand limited runway, shifting requirements, and decisions that have to be right the first time.
- **Pragmatic, scale-ready architecture.** Serverless-first, cost-aware, and secure by default — practical for day one but built to grow.
- **GenAI in production, not slideware.** I build AI-enhanced products and develop with AI tooling daily, so I can guide founders through model selection, cost, latency, and safety trade-offs.
- **I build for founder pain points.** I created a Startup Project Management System to streamline client engagements — proof I don't just understand how early-stage teams work, I build tools around it.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

AWS & Cloud: Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Cognito, Amplify (Gen 2), S3, CloudFront, EC2, RDS, IAM, CloudFormation, AWS SAM, CloudWatch · Serverless architecture · Infrastructure as Code · CI/CD (CodePipeline, CodeBuild, GitHub Actions)

GenAI & ML: AWS Bedrock, SageMaker, Rekognition, Comprehend · AI-assisted development · Foundation model integration · RAG & vector-data concepts · Model cost/latency/safety trade-offs

Development: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Node.js · React, Next.js · REST & GraphQL APIs · PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Prisma ORM · Docker · JWT/OAuth · Agile/Scrum

Advisory: Technical consulting · Requirements gathering · Teaching & curriculum design · Technical writing · Developer community engagement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Solutions Architect / App Developer — Atlanta Creative Exchange LC

Atlanta, GA · 2024 – Present

- Founded and operate an independent app development business delivering production, cloud-native applications on AWS for private clients.
- Act as the technical advisor on every engagement: gather requirements, recommend pragmatic architectures, and balance build decisions against budget, timeline, and future scale — the trusted-advisor role founders need.
- Architect serverless solutions (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Cognito, Amplify, S3, CloudFront) that stay cheap early and scale with usage.
- Built a **Startup Project Management System** — a product managing the full client engagement lifecycle (intake, requirements, milestones, status) designed around the real pain points early-stage teams face scoping and tracking technical work.
- Own projects end to end — architecture, development, deployment, and support. Client details withheld under NDA.

Founder & Lead Developer — ClassCast (AI-Enhanced EdTech Platform)

Atlanta, GA · 2023 – Present

- Took an AI-enhanced learning platform from concept to production serving **250+ active users**, owning every architecture and technology decision — the full founder journey.
- Integrated AI-powered learning analytics and video workflows, navigating real GenAI trade-offs around accuracy, cost, and UX.
- Shipped a second production app (Chord Progression App) on **AWS Amplify Gen 2** with Cognito, DynamoDB, and S3 — demonstrating repeatable cloud-native delivery.
- Stack: TypeScript, Next.js, React, PostgreSQL, Prisma ORM; JWT auth, encrypted storage, FERPA-compliant data protection.

AI Coding & Cloud Development Instructor — Cristo Rey Atlanta Jesuit High School

Atlanta, GA · 2023 – Present

- Teach an AI Coding Fundamentals and Cloud App Development course covering AI-assisted development, AWS architecture, and modern application design.
- Translate complex cloud/AI concepts into clear, actionable lessons — the same skill needed to guide non-expert founders — and create original curriculum and reference projects.

Earlier Experience

- **Professional Educator** (Atlanta Public Schools, Drew Charter, Cristo Rey · 2009–2014, 2023–Present) — Taught math and computer science; increased team performance 21.4% through technology integration.
- **Signal Support Systems Specialist, Sergeant — U.S. Army** (2005–2009) — Senior LAN Manager leading 24-hour tactical network ops for 500+ personnel; managed $1.5M+ equipment with zero loss; led a team of 5.
- **Systems Analyst / Computer Operator — Heartland Payment Systems** (2002–2004) — Maintained network and applications in a Fortune 500 payment environment sustaining 99.9% uptime.

FEATURED PROJECTS

- **ClassCast** · *class-cast.com* · 250+ users — AI-enhanced EdTech platform for video assignments and peer learning. TypeScript, Next.js, React, PostgreSQL, Prisma, FERPA-compliant.
- **Startup Project Management System** — Product running the full client engagement lifecycle (intake → requirements → milestones → status), built around founder pain points.
- **Chord Progression App** · AWS Amplify Gen 2 · 30+ users — Serverless app with Cognito, DynamoDB, S3, Tone.js. Demonstrates end-to-end AWS delivery.
- **Multi-Tenant SaaS Architecture** *(in progress)* — Cloud-native, tenant-scoped app on AWS with Cognito, DynamoDB, API Gateway + Lambda, and EventBridge workflows.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Cloud Application Developer Program — AWS Cloud Institute · 2024–2025

Scalable AWS architectures, secure VPC networking, CI/CD automation, serverless apps (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB), AI/ML integration (SageMaker, Rekognition, Bedrock); 100+ hands-on labs and capstone projects.

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics — South Carolina State University · 2001

Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner · AWS Certified Developer – Associate · Secret Security Clearance (held) · Information Assurance Security Officer

Local to Atlanta, GA and available on-site. References available upon request.